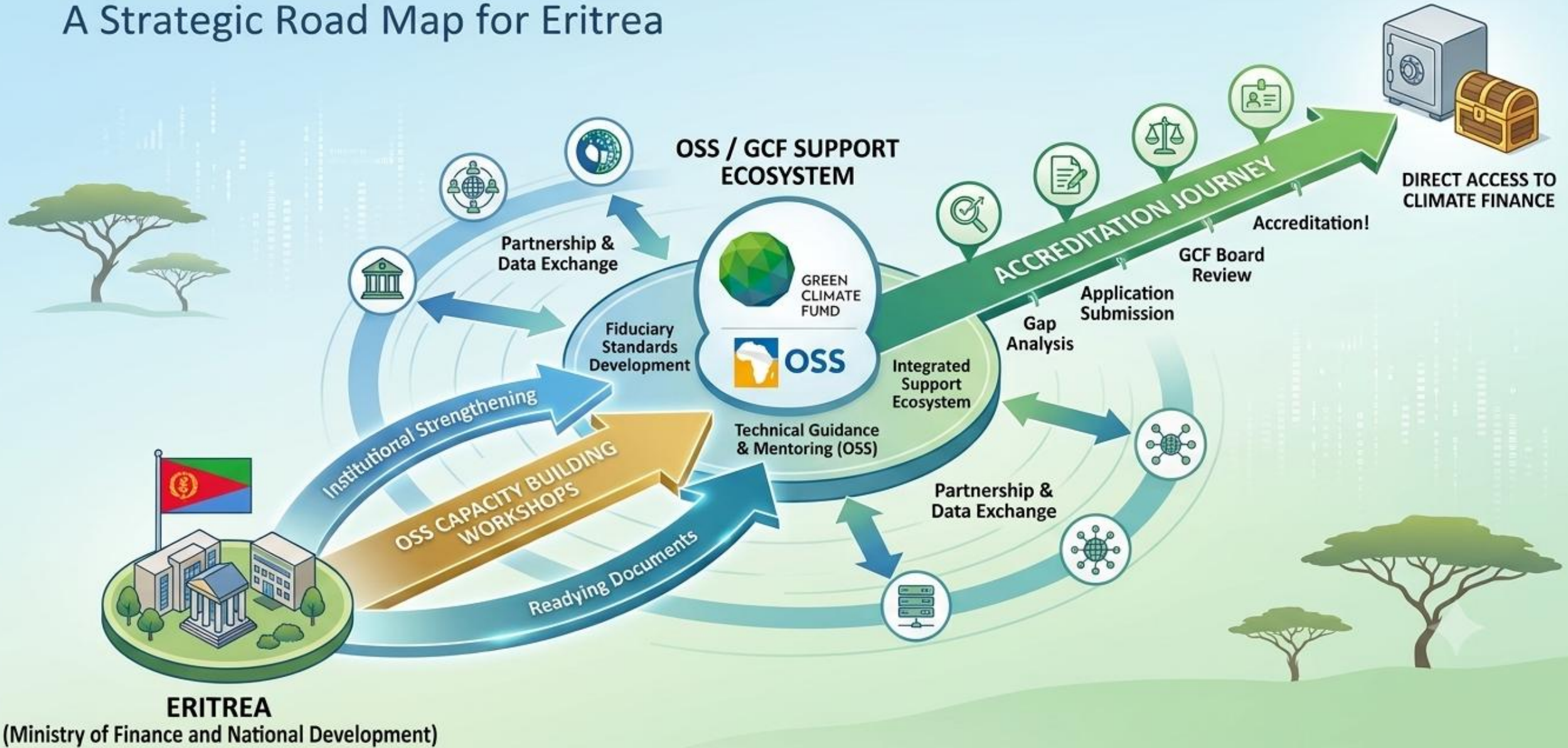


GCF Accreditation Capacity Building Training

A Strategic Road Map for Eritrea



Understanding the standards and steps for effective
accreditation

MODULE 1: GCF ACCREDITATION FRAMEWORK, PRINCIPLES, PROCESS, AND IMPLEMENTATION



OPENING AND CONTEXT



PURPOSE

Role of Accreditation Framework

Accreditation ensures institutions qualify as trusted partners to access and manage GCF resources effectively.

Institutional Commitment Importance

Accreditation requires sustained leadership, cross-departmental coordination, and continuous improvement within institutions.

Alignment with Long-term Engagement

Accreditation is a strategic investment aligning participant mindset with GCF's long-term climate finance goals.



SCOPE

Focused Module Scope

The module focuses on application-oriented content, excluding foundational GCF topics covered earlier.

Core Accreditation Areas

Covers six guiding principles, five-step accreditation process, and key changes in the Revised Accreditation Framework.

Roles and Responsibilities

Clarifies the distinction between Accredited Entities and Executing Entities in the GCF process.



OBJECTIVES



Competency-Based Objectives

Objectives focus on knowledge, practical application, and explanation to ensure comprehensive learning.

Understanding the Accreditation Process

Participants learn to describe principles and steps of accreditation for institutional decision-making.

Roles Clarification

Clear distinction between Accredited Entities and Executing Entities supports stakeholder engagement.



OVERVIEW OF GCF ACCREDITATION AS AN INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP

Partnership Model

GCF accreditation is a long-term partnership based on mutual trust and shared climate goals, not just funding.

High Standards and Responsibilities

Accredited institutions must uphold governance, financial, environmental, and social standards with transparency.

Ongoing Obligations and Opportunities

Accreditation grants repeated funding access and programmatic opportunities with continuous reporting and compliance.



WHY ACCREDITATION MATTERS FOR CLIMATE FINANCE ACCESS



Accreditation as Risk Management

Accreditation acts as a rigorous risk management tool enabling safe scaling of climate finance to diverse institutions.

Benefits of Accreditation

Accreditation increases national ownership, reduces intermediaries, and aligns funding with country priorities.

Institutional Credibility and Sustainability

Accreditation enhances institutional credibility, governance, and long-term sustainability beyond mere compliance.

Challenges and Commitment

Accreditation requires resources and sustained leadership commitment, balancing opportunities with responsibilities.



LINK BETWEEN ACCREDITATION AND NATIONAL CLIMATE PRIORITIES (NAP)



Accreditation and Climate Strategies

Accredited institutions must align with national climate strategies like NDCs and low-emission development plans.

Role of National Designated Authority

Nomination by the national designated authority formalizes alignment and is required for accreditation.

Strengthening Institutional Linkages

Strong policy linkages and coordination improve institutional relevance and impact in climate governance.

Integrated National Climate Response

Accredited institutions function within a coordinated national framework for planning and accountability.



PRINCIPLES GUIDING GCF ACCREDITATION



PRINCIPLE 1: COUNTRY OWNERSHIP



Alignment with National Priorities

Country ownership ensures projects align with national climate strategies and priorities led by domestic institutions.

Institutional Mandate and Coordination

GCF assesses institutions for clear mandates and strong coordination with ministries and stakeholders.

Accountability to National Systems

Institutions demonstrate accountability to national systems through governance, budgeting, and partnerships supporting climate needs.

Local Buy-in and Sustainability

Country ownership avoids externally driven projects lacking local buy-in, ensuring sustainable and credible impact.



PRINCIPLE 2: ALIGNMENT WITH THE GCF PURPOSE

Core Purpose of GCF

GCF focuses on shifting financial flows toward low-emission and climate-resilient development pathways, avoiding business-as-usual funding.

Strategic Climate Vision

Institutions must demonstrate a clear climate rationale, ambition, and understanding of mitigation and adaptation to drive systemic change.

Transformative Impact Priority

GCF prioritizes projects with paradigm shift potential, long-term sustainability, and addressing market barriers and policy reforms.



PRINCIPLE 3: FIDUCIARY STANDARDS AND FINANCIAL INTEGRITY



Scope of Fiduciary Standards

Fiduciary standards include financial management, accounting, internal controls, procurement, audit, and anti-corruption measures.

Evidence-Based Assessment

Assessment relies on documented policies, procedures, and track record instead of intentions for transparency and accountability.

Importance of Implementation

Fiduciary standards are living systems that must be consistently applied across organizations to ensure integrity.

Risks of Weak Controls

Weak procurement, unclear duty segregation, or poor audits can cause risks and delay accreditation.



PRINCIPLE 4: PREDICTABILITY AND CONSISTENCY OF DECISIONS



Rules-Based Transparent Decisions

Accreditation decisions are based on clear rules and transparency to ensure fairness and clarity for all applicants.

Consistency Across Applicants

Similar cases are treated similarly with consistent application of requirements, fostering trust and fairness.

Predictability Enhances Planning

Predictability reduces uncertainty, allowing institutions to plan better and allocate resources efficiently.

Clear Timelines and Procedures

Fixed application windows and clearer timelines improve the predictability and reliability of the accreditation process.



PRINCIPLE 5: COMPLEMENTARITY WITH OTHER FINANCE MECHANISMS

Avoiding Duplication

GCF activities must add value without duplicating efforts in the existing climate finance landscape.

Coordination with Funding Sources

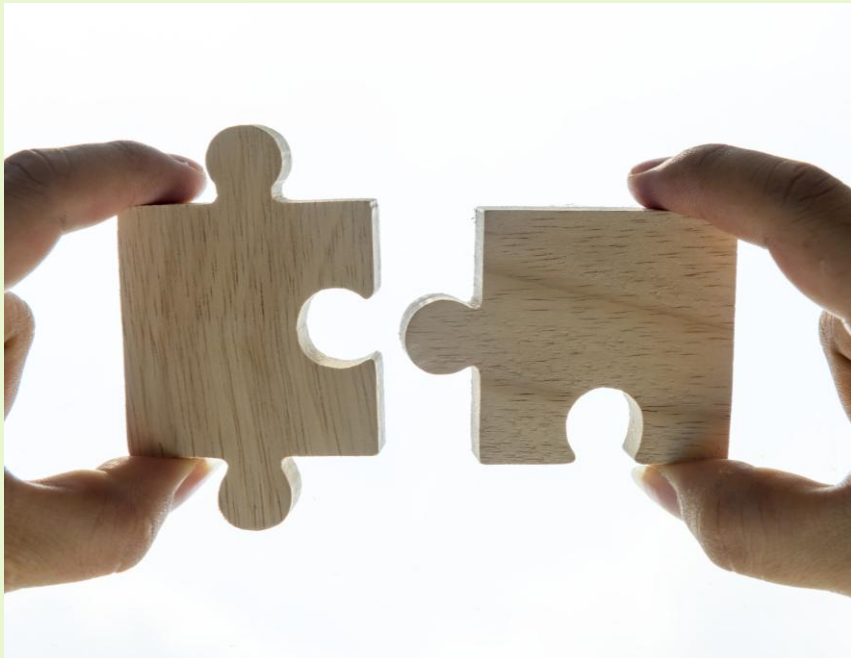
Institutions should coordinate and leverage co-financing with multilateral, bilateral, and private investors.

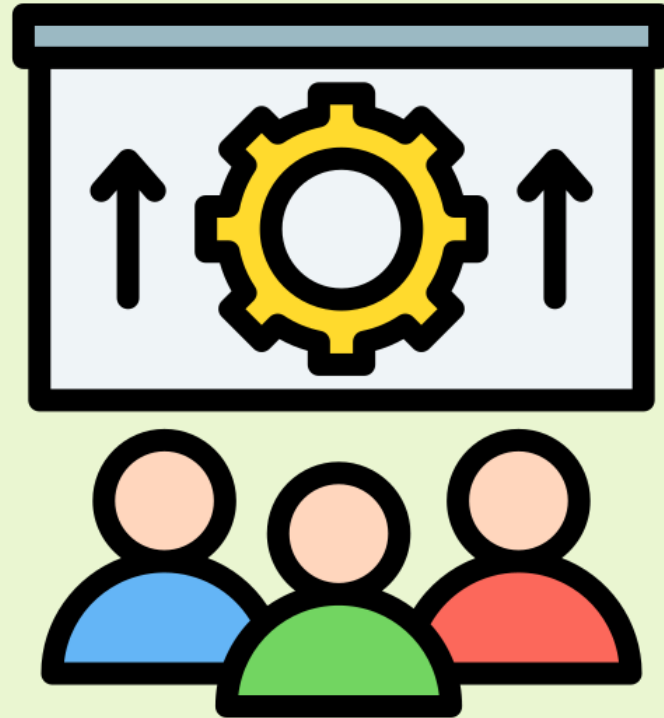
Strategic Synergies

Building on existing initiatives through blending finance and scaling pilot projects maximizes impact.

Planning and Engagement

Strong planning and stakeholder engagement are essential for demonstrating complementarity effectively.





PRINCIPLE 6: CAPACITY BUILDING AND INSTITUTIONAL STRENGTHENING

Capacity Building Importance

Capacity building is a core focus to strengthen institutions and improve climate finance delivery over time.

Accreditation as Development

Accreditation is seen as a long-term development process, encouraging continuous learning and improvement.

Variable Institutional Capacity

Institutions have varying capacities and risk levels, growing through experience and targeted support.

Sustainability and Resilience

Building capacity supports sustainability and resilience in climate finance delivery systems.



THE ACCREDITATION PROCESS IN PRACTICE



OVERVIEW OF THE FIVE-STEP ACCREDITATION PROCESS

Structured Five-Step Process

The accreditation process follows five key stages: nomination, pre-screening, full application, detailed review, and board approval.

Risk Management Focus

Each step includes risk management to ensure only qualified institutions progress, preventing early-stage failures.

Competitive and Resource-Intensive

The process is competitive and requires careful planning and coordination due to resource demands and strict requirements.

Visualizing Bottlenecks

Presenting the process as a sequence helps identify common bottlenecks and prepares participants for detailed discussions ahead.





STEP 1: GOVERNMENT NOMINATION

Formal National Nomination

Nomination confirms the institution's recognition by national authorities as a suitable partner for GCF resources.

Prerequisite for Application

Nomination is required before submitting an accreditation application, reflecting country ownership principles.

Engagement and Review

Effective nomination involves government review, stakeholder consultation, and alignment with national policies.



STEP 2: PRE-SCREENING AND ELIGIBILITY CHECKS

Purpose of Pre-Screening

Pre-screening filters out applications that do not meet basic eligibility requirements to ensure quality and compliance.

Assessment Criteria

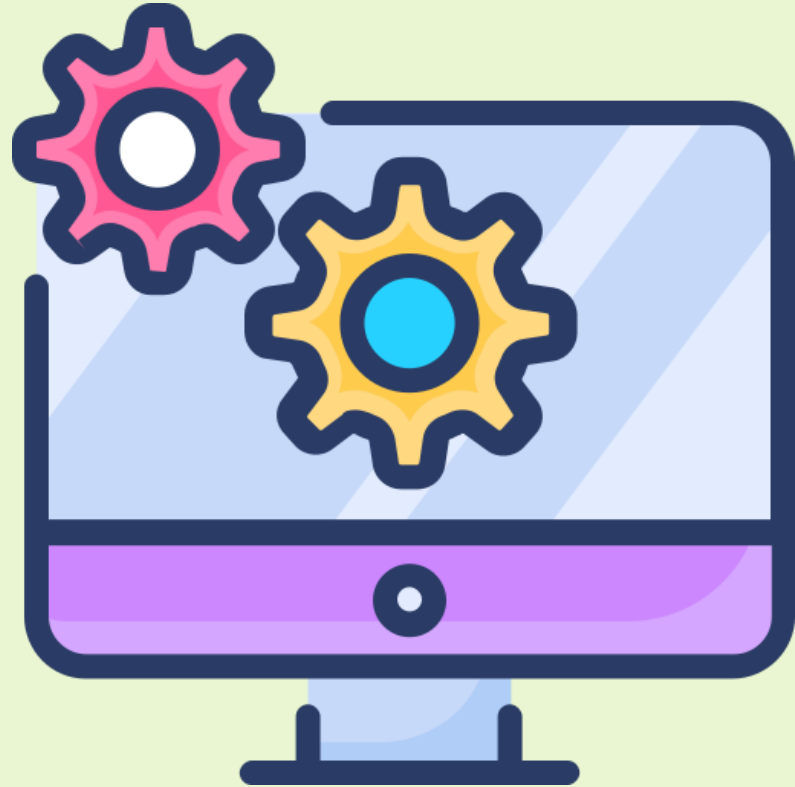
GCF assesses legal status, governance, financial systems, procurement policies, integrity standards, and project management capacity.

Evidence-Based Process

Pre-screening relies on clear documentation submitted by institutions to validate eligibility and compliance.

Common Challenges

Outdated policies or unclear legal mandates can cause delays or rejections during the pre-screening process.



STEP 3: FULL ACCREDITATION APPLICATION

Comprehensive Documentation

Institutions must submit detailed documentation covering fiduciary standards, gender policies, and environmental safeguards through the partner portal.

Timing and Preparation

Applications are accepted only during fixed annual windows, making careful timing and preparation critical for success.

Cross-Department Coordination

The process requires collaboration among multiple departments, highlighting the resource-intensive nature of the application.

Consistency and Clarity

Ensuring clarity and consistency across all submitted documents is essential to meet accreditation requirements effectively.



STEP 4: SECRETARIAT REVIEW AND PANEL ASSESSMENT



Comprehensive Application Review

The Secretariat and Accreditation Panel perform a detailed assessment of applications, ensuring thorough evaluation.

Information Requests

Reviewers may request additional information to clarify or supplement applications, requiring prompt responses.

Technical and Institutional Assessment

Panel evaluates technical compliance alongside institutional credibility to ensure eligibility and reliability.

Effective Communication

Clear communication and coordination within institutions are vital to manage expectations and maintain progress.



STEP 5: BOARD DECISION AND ACCREDITATION ACTIVATION



Board Approval Process

The GCF Board makes the final decision to approve or reject accreditation based on panel recommendations.

Indefinite Accreditation

Accreditation is granted indefinitely under the Revised Framework but requires periodic performance reporting.

Legal Agreements and Responsibilities

Legal agreements are signed at first project approval, marking the start of compliance and engagement responsibilities.

Ongoing Compliance Obligations

Accredited institutions must maintain active reporting and compliance as part of their partnership with GCF.



REVISED ACCREDITATION FRAMEWORK AND INSTITUTIONAL ROLES



INTRODUCTION TO THE REVISED ACCREDITATION FRAMEWORK



Framework Updates Overview

The Revised Accreditation Framework updates key system elements to enhance efficiency and risk management.

Effective Date and Scope

Revisions apply to all applications submitted from October 2025 onward.

Key Objectives

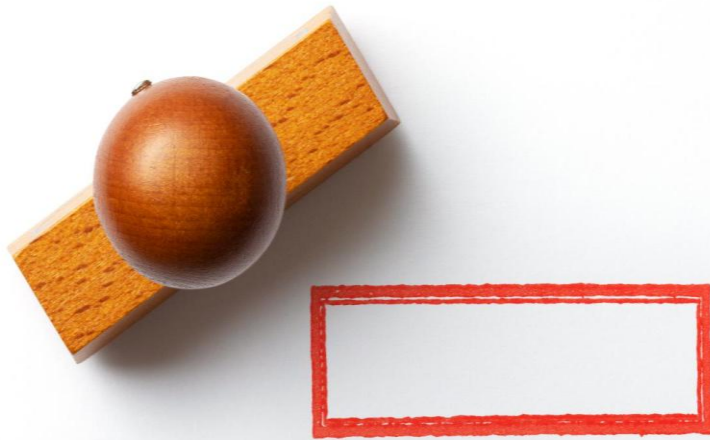
Objectives include reducing administrative burden, clarifying timelines, and enhancing project-level oversight.

Continuous Improvement

Revisions are part of a continuous improvement process to increase predictability and effectiveness.



KEY CHANGE: INDEFINITE ACCREDITATION AND PERFORMANCE REPORTING



Shift to Indefinite Accreditation

Institutions now receive indefinite accreditation, eliminating the need for reaccreditation every five years.

Periodic Performance Reporting

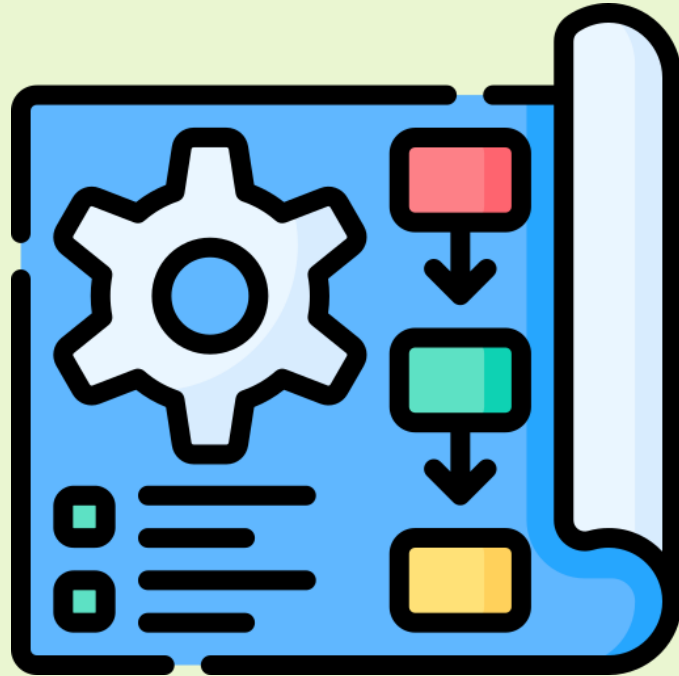
Regular performance reports ensure ongoing compliance and effective use of resources under the new framework.

Accountability and Corrective Actions

Poor performance can trigger corrective actions or suspension, maintaining strong accountability standards.

Long-term Institutional Planning

Institutions can focus on sustained engagement rather than cyclical reaccreditation efforts.



KEY CHANGE: FIXED APPLICATION WINDOWS

Fixed Annual Windows

Applications must be submitted during designated periods under the revised framework, replacing rolling submissions.

Improved Predictability

Fixed windows enhance predictability for applicants and reviewers, improving overall process transparency.

Preparation and Timing

Institutions must plan backward from deadlines, ensuring all documentation is complete and validated beforehand.

Consequences of Missing Windows

Missing the application window causes delays, emphasizing the critical nature of timely submission.



KEY CHANGE: PROJECT-LEVEL DUE DILIGENCE



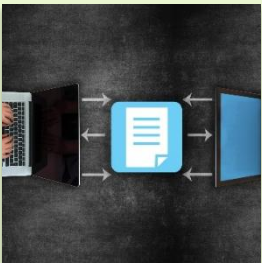
Project-Level Compliance

Institutions must demonstrate compliance for each project, not just at the entity level, ensuring thorough review.



Risk Management in Context

Project-level due diligence allows risks to be assessed and managed specifically within each project's unique context.



Operationalizing Policies

Institutions need to consistently apply policies across projects through internal screening, assessment, and documentation.



ROLE OF THE ACCREDITED ENTITY

Primary Contractual Role

The Accredited Entity acts as the main contractual counterpart to the Green Climate Fund, holding direct responsibility.

Fund Management and Compliance

Entities manage funds while ensuring adherence to fiduciary, environmental, social, and gender standards.

Accountability and Reporting

Accountability to GCF cannot be delegated and requires thorough performance reporting regardless of partner implementation.

Risk and Responsibility

Understanding accreditation requires recognizing the significant responsibilities and risks involved in this role.





ROLE OF THE EXECUTING ENTITY AND RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

Role of Executing Entities

Executing Entities implement project activities on the ground under Accredited Entity supervision without requiring direct accreditation.

Compliance and Standards

Executing Entities must comply with standards and procedures established by Accredited Entities for project integrity.

Contractual and Monitoring Systems

Clear contracts and monitoring systems ensure accountability and effective project delivery by Executing Entities.

Relationship Management

Effective relationship management between Accredited and Executing Entities is crucial for project success and compliance.



APPLICATION, CHALLENGES, AND KEY TAKEAWAYS



COMMON INSTITUTIONAL CHALLENGES IN ACCREDITATION

Fiduciary System Gaps

Many institutions face gaps in fiduciary systems that impact financial accountability during accreditation.

Unclear Governance

Unclear governance arrangements hinder effective decision-making and institutional compliance.

Limited Documentation

Insufficient or incomplete documentation creates obstacles to meeting accreditation standards.

Systemic Challenges as Opportunities

Viewing systemic issues as opportunities encourages constructive problem-solving and organizational growth.



IMPORTANCE OF INTERNAL COORDINATION AND LEADERSHIP

Cross-Department Engagement

Accreditation requires active collaboration among finance, procurement, legal, environmental, and program teams to succeed.

Leadership Support

Strong leadership is vital for resource allocation, overcoming challenges, and maintaining accreditation momentum.

Avoiding Isolated Efforts

Treating accreditation as an organization-wide initiative prevents failure common with isolated technical approaches.



USING SELF-ASSESSMENT AND GAP ANALYSIS EFFECTIVELY



Honest Self-Assessment Importance

Honest self-assessment helps institutions identify gaps and align with accreditation requirements accurately.

Prioritizing Actions by Risk

Prioritize improvement actions based on risk and feasibility to optimize resource allocation and impact.

Building Trust and Capacity

Credible self-assessment fosters trust with reviewers and supports targeted capacity-building plans.

Avoiding Overestimation Risks

Overestimating readiness can cause delays and reputational damage during accreditation.



KEY TAKEAWAYS



Strategic Nature of Accreditation

Accreditation is a strategic process that aligns organizational goals with quality standards.

Principles and Process Importance

Understanding core principles and following the correct processes ensures effective accreditation outcomes.

Framework Changes Impact

Recent changes in accreditation frameworks affect both technical and organizational dimensions.

Supporting Retention and Reference

Summarizing key points aids retention and serves as a guide for future learning sessions.



THANK YOU

Next Module

The next training stage will cover legal eligibility and pre-screening requirements.



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